

Explore with the AI Assistant

Activity · Prompting techniques · ~20 min

Before you start

- ☐ You've worked through **Build a clear prompt**
- ☐ The AI Assistant panel is open in your country's project

Why this matters

Small changes to a prompt produce noticeably different outputs. This exercise builds intuition for that, in three steps: start with a base prompt, change one variable, then ask a follow-up.

Step 1 — Try this base prompt

Type the prompt below into the AI Assistant. You can paste it exactly:

Show ANC1 service utilization by region over the last 12 months.

It works because it names three things explicitly:

- **What** — ANC1
- **Where** — by region
- **When** — last 12 months

Step 2 — Change one thing

Now run the prompt again, but change **one** element. Pick one variation:

- **Different indicator:** *Show BCG dose by region over the last 12 months.*
- **Different time period:** *Show ANC1 by region for 2023 and 2024.*
- **Different geographic level:** *Show ANC1 by district over the last 12 months.*

Notice how changing a single word changes the output.

Step 3 — Ask a follow-up

Pick one of these follow-ups (or write your own). The conversation can keep going:

- *Show this as a bar chart.*
- *Which region had the biggest change?*
- *Add Pental to the comparison.*

Save what's useful

Anything you produce that you'd want to keep — a chart, an interpretation — save it to your personal folder before moving on.

Tips

One variable at a time. Changing two things at once makes it hard to tell which change drove the difference. Vary one element, observe, then vary the next.

Don't worry about being polite. The AI doesn't need please-and-thank-you. Be direct.

What's next

Move on to **Iterative vs single-prompt** to compare two ways of building the same output.